

Chapter

Guru and Disciple — The Highest Form of Love



Introduction: To Recognise the Guru Is to Recognise God

We use the word "love" very casually. But in this short discourse Acharya Upendra ji explains that real love is not so easy — and that its door opens through the Guru. His talk begins with a profound statement:

"The day you can recognise the Guru — anyone, anyone who can recognise the Guru in his true form — understand that in that very moment you have recognised God too."

To recognise the Guru in his true form is to recognise God. And along with that recognition, another understanding awakens:

"Then on that same day one will also understand what love is, because love is God."

1. Love Is God — Real Love Is Understood in the Final Birth

According to Acharya ji, love and God are one — **love is God**. That is why understanding real love is no ordinary achievement:

"It is in the final birth that one understands what love is — real love. Love is God. It is not such an easy, such a simple path."

Here **the final birth** points to the birth after which one does not have to be born again — the end of the cycle of birth and death. Acharya ji gives the proof of this from the life of Shri Krishna and Radha:

"If it were such a simple path, the life of Shri Krishna and Radha would be understood. One understands it in the final birth."

The love of Shri Krishna and Radha is not understood by everyone; the capacity to understand it comes only in the final birth.

2. If Not Love, Then What?

If real love is understood only in the final birth, then what is it that we call love in the births before it? Acharya ji says clearly:

"So this means that in all the births before the final birth, there will be no such thing as love. In them there will be either moha, or attachment, attraction, or coercion — there will be a lot, but there will not be love."

Four feelings are named here, which we often mistake for love:

- **Moha** — attachment born of ignorance, which veils the truth
- **Asakti (attachment)** — clinging to a person or a thing
- **Akarshan (attraction)** — being pulled towards an outer form or quality
- **Coercion** — imposing one's claim on another

All of these are "a lot", but they are not love.

3. To Learn Love, Go to the Guru

So where is love to be learned? Acharya ji's answer is — from the one who has experienced it himself:

"To learn love, [one has to come] to the Guru, who has had that experience, [whose] heart chakra has already awakened."

The **heart chakra** (Anahata chakra) is one of the seven main energy centres of the body, believed to be located at the centre of the chest and associated with love and compassion. **Only one whose heart chakra is awakened can give the**

experience of love — that is why love is learned from the Guru.

4. The Mark of a True Disciple

After the recognition of the Guru, Acharya ji describes the mark of the disciple. His test is simple, yet hard:

"Second, with the Guru, one day — the one who develops the habit of listening in full, exactly as he has spoken, is the one called a true disciple."

The habit of listening to what the Guru has said in full, exactly as it was said, without adding or subtracting anything of one's own — this is the mark of a true disciple.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 To recognise the Guru in his true form is, in that very moment, to recognise God.
- 2 Love is God — love and God are one, so the one who recognises the Guru also understands love.

- 3** **Real love is understood in the final birth;** this path is not so simple — if it were, the life of Shri Krishna and Radha would be understood by all.
- 4** **In the births before it there is moha, attachment, attraction or coercion** — a lot, but not love.
- 5** **To learn love, one must go to the Guru** who has experienced it and whose heart chakra is awakened.
- 6** **The true disciple is the one** who develops the habit of listening to the Guru's words in full, exactly as they were spoken.